

Chapter recap

Last updated April 2026

Nice work!

The ternary operator

Short if conditions can sometimes be written using the ternary operator. The ternary operator is a short way of writing an if ... else statement.

Let's go back to the solution of the previous challenge:

```
function evenOrOdd(number) {  
  if (number % 2 === 0) {  
    return "even";  
  }  
  return "odd";  
}
```

It can be written using the ternary operator as follows:

```
function evenOrOdd(number) {  
  return (number % 2 === 0) ? "even" : "odd";  
}
```

The ternary operator has the following syntax:

```
condition ? expressionWhenTrue : expressionWhenFalse
```

While the ternary operator can make your code more concise, it can also make it less readable. We generally recommend you avoid it and opt for more readable code.

About the instructor



Speaking at the Google Developer Experts summit about the lessons I learned while teaching programming

If you're interested in my frontend posts, follow me on [X](#). If you're a fan of cats or snowboarding, you can follow me on [Instagram](#). You can also subscribe to my [Tech YouTube channel](#).

 Please note that I am happy to offer support through this website (Help Center at the bottom-right corner of the page), but unfortunately, not through social platforms such as X/Instagram.

In the next chapter, we'll start working with arrays. See you there!

Chapter Recap

- Using an **if** condition, you can run a piece of code when the condition evaluates to true
- The syntax is `if (condition)` and then curly braces `{ }` wrap the lines of code that correspond to this condition



- When you have an `if/else` condition that returns two different results, it is possible to drop the `else` keyword.
- Always use triple equals (`===`) when comparing the equality of 2 values in JavaScript.
- When you're returning a boolean from a function, you can simplify your code by returning the boolean expression directly, without using an `if` statement.
- The division remainder of a number divided by two is either `0` or `1`. This helps us determine whether the number is even or odd.

Was this helpful?

